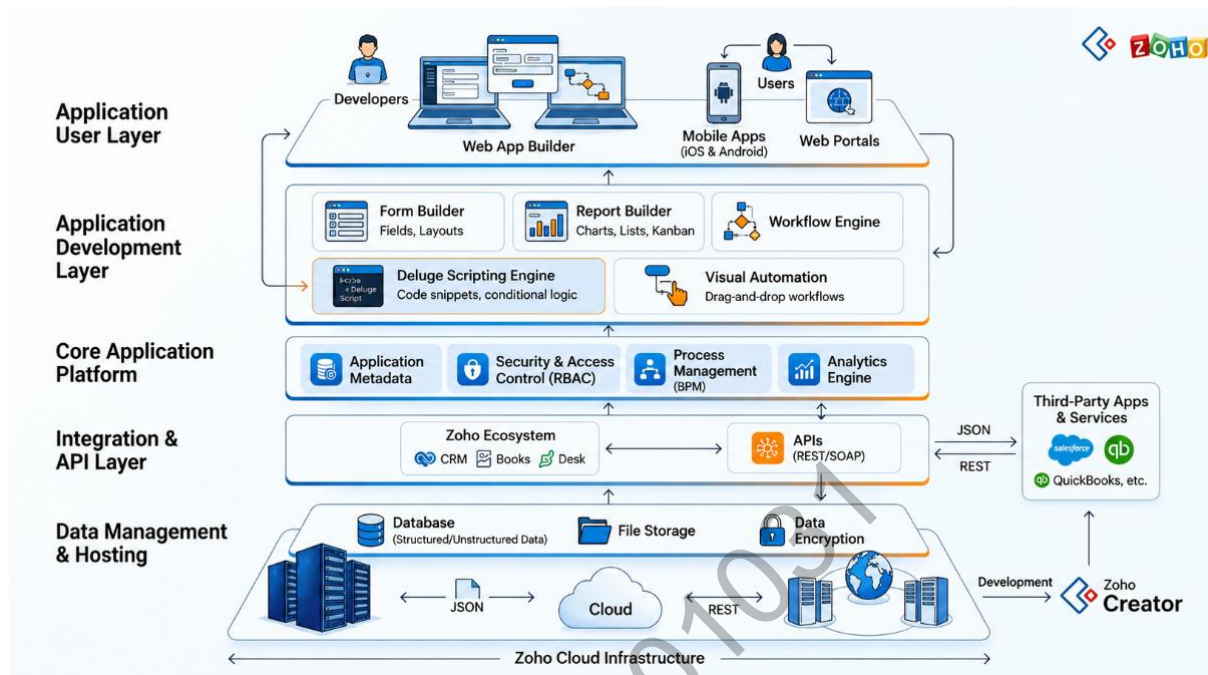


Platform Architecture and Interface Documentation

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Year/Semester	III year / V Semester
Course	Low-Code Application Development using Zoho Creator

Platform Architecture and Interface Documentation



Introduction

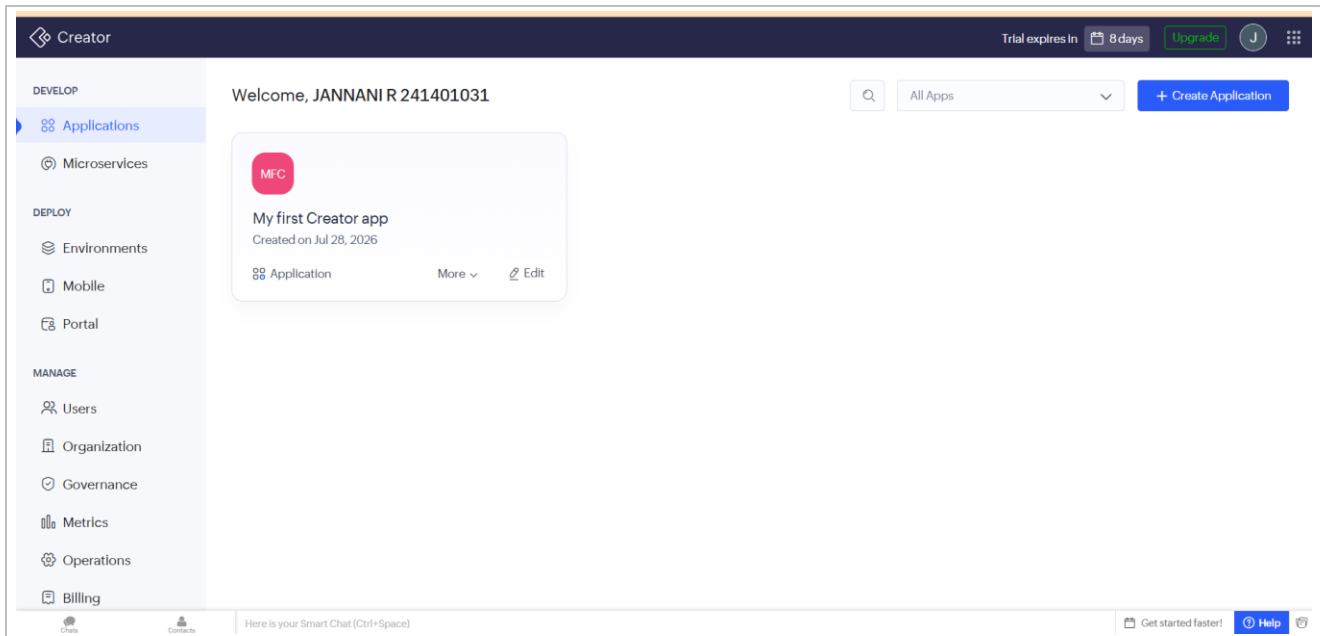
This architecture diagram illustrates the layered framework of the **Zoho Creator Low-Code Platform**, which enables organizations to rapidly develop, deploy, and manage business applications with minimal coding. The platform provides a complete ecosystem that integrates application development, workflow automation, data management, APIs, and cloud hosting into a single environment.

The architecture is organized into five major layers:

- **Application User Layer** – Provides access to web applications, mobile applications, and web portals for end users.
- **Application Development Layer** – Includes tools such as Form Builder, Report Builder, Workflow Engine, Visual Automation, and Deluge scripting for building applications efficiently.
- **Core Application Platform** – Handles application metadata, security, role-based access control (RBAC), business process management (BPM), and analytics.
- **Integration & API Layer** – Enables seamless integration with Zoho services and third-party applications through REST and SOAP APIs.
- **Data Management & Hosting Layer** – Manages databases, file storage, encryption, and cloud infrastructure to ensure secure and reliable application hosting.

Overall, this layered architecture simplifies application development while ensuring scalability, security, and seamless integration, making it an ideal platform for developing enterprise-grade solutions.

Feature Name: Applications



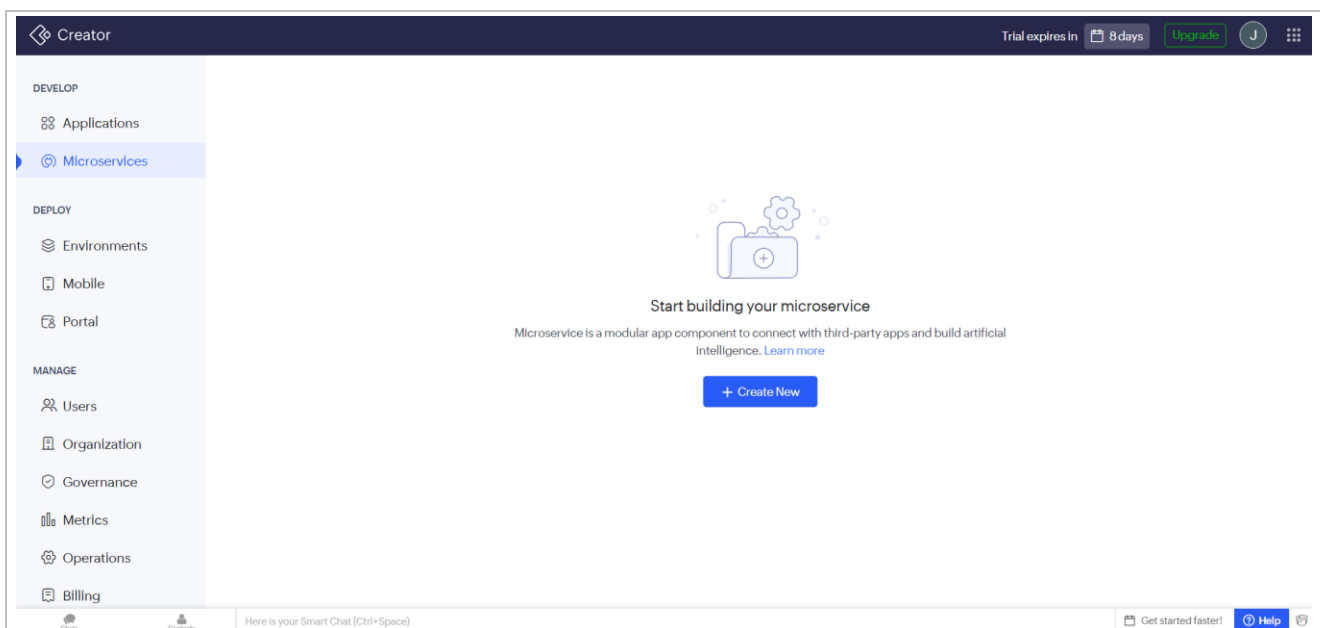
Purpose

The Zoho Creator Dashboard serves as the central workspace for developing, managing, deploying, and monitoring low-code applications. It provides developers with all the tools needed to build applications, manage users, integrate services, and oversee application performance from a single interface.

Description

The Zoho Creator Dashboard is the main interface displayed after login. It includes a navigation panel for development, deployment, and management tasks, along with a workspace that lists all created applications. From this dashboard, users can create new applications, edit existing ones, manage users and security, deploy applications to web or mobile platforms, and monitor application usage and performance. It acts as the control center for the entire application development lifecycle.

Feature Name: Microservices



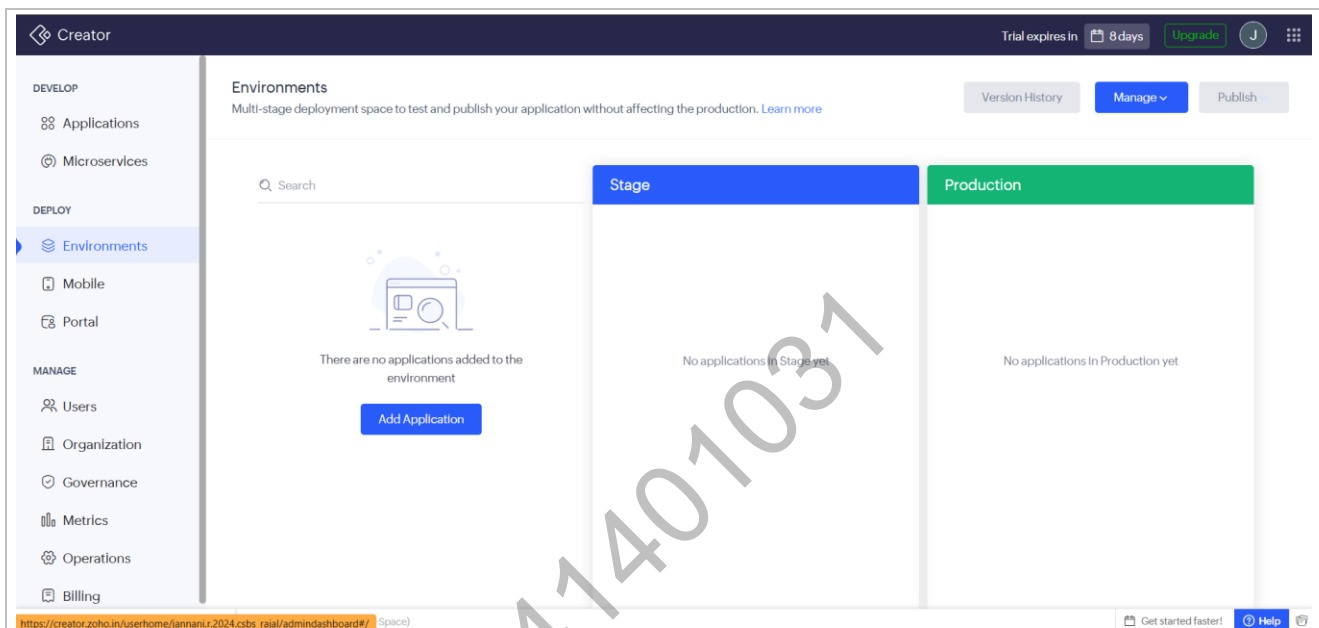
Purpose

The Microservices feature is used to build small, independent backend services that perform specific tasks. It helps developers create reusable business logic, process data, and expose APIs without affecting the main application.

Description

Microservices in Zoho Creator allow developers to divide complex applications into smaller, manageable services. Each microservice is designed to handle a single function, such as processing payments, sending notifications, or validating user data. These services can communicate with applications through APIs, making the system more scalable, flexible, and easier to maintain.

Feature Name: Environments



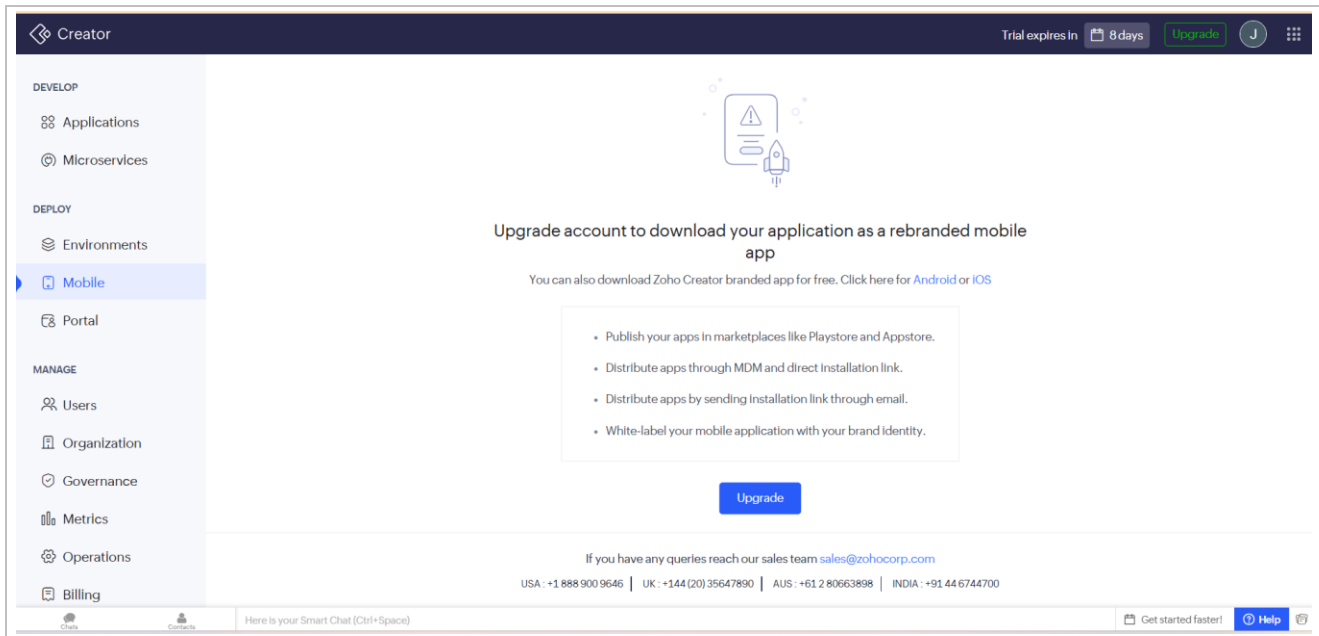
Purpose

The Environments feature in Zoho Creator is used to manage different stages of an application's lifecycle, allowing developers to develop, test, and deploy applications safely before making them available to end users.

Description

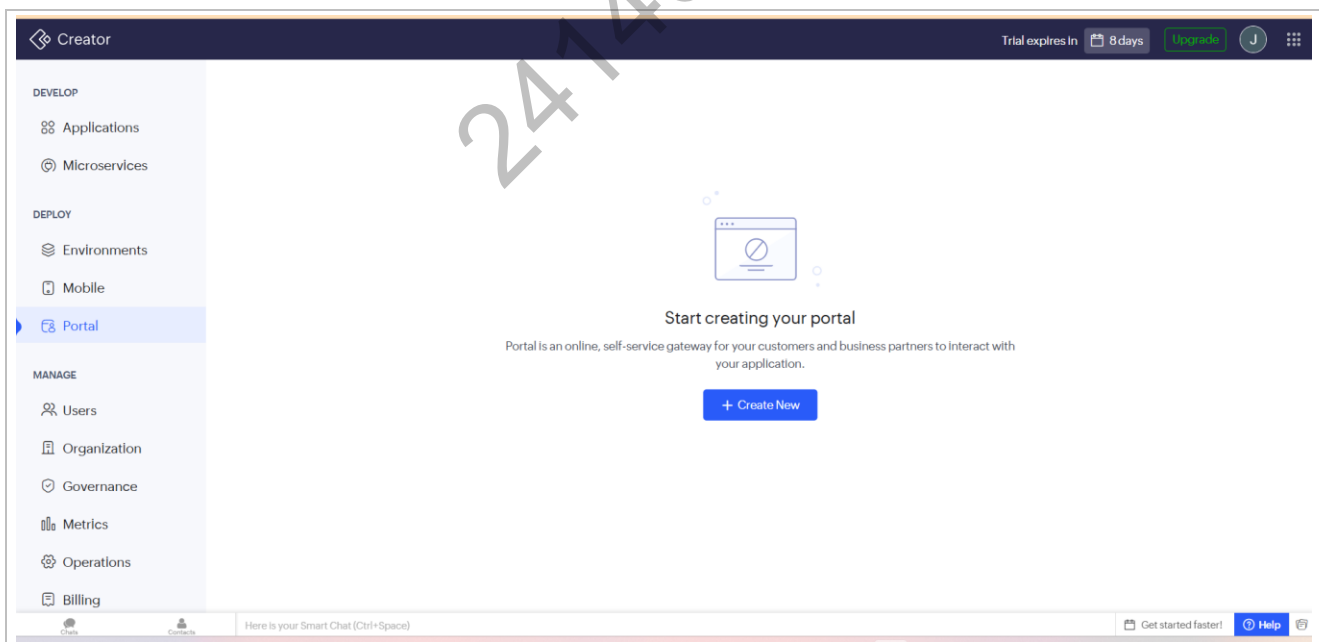
Environments provide separate workspaces for Development, Testing, and Production. Developers first build and modify the application in the Development environment, test new features and bug fixes in the Testing environment, and finally deploy the stable version to the Production environment for end users. This approach helps prevent errors, ensures application stability, and enables smooth updates without affecting the live application.

Feature Name: Mobile



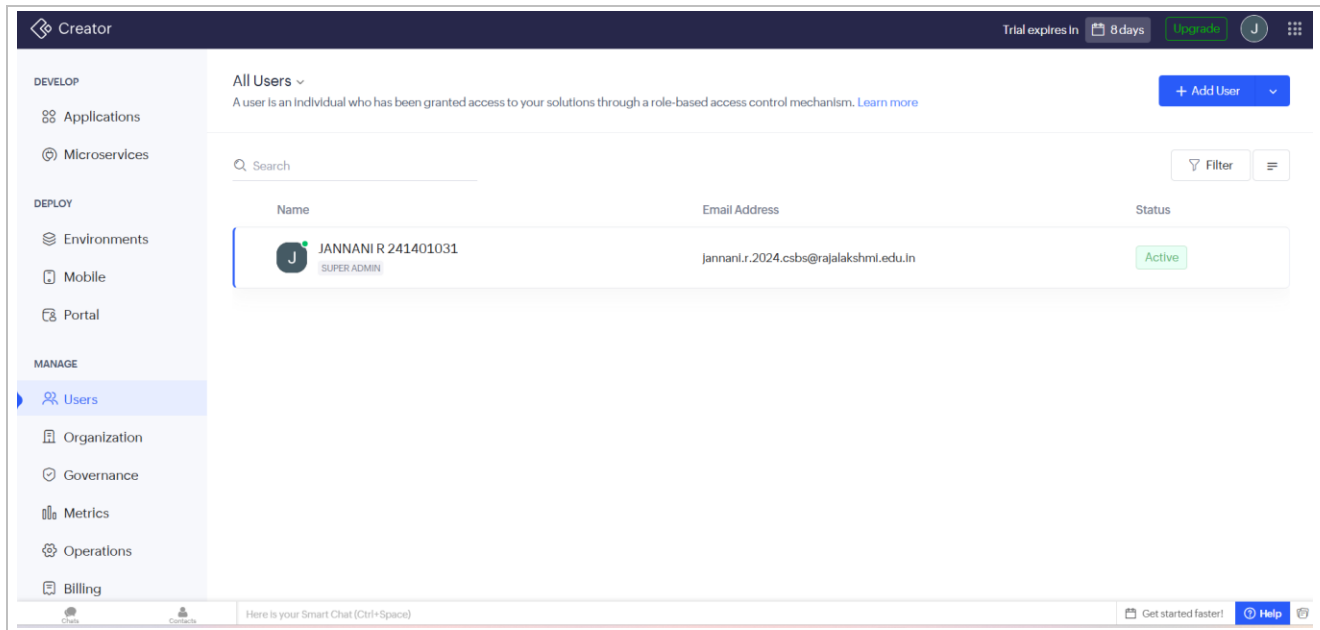
The Mobile module converts Zoho Creator applications into Android and iOS apps. Users can access apps through the Zoho Creator mobile app, or with a paid upgrade, publish a fully branded app on the Play Store or App Store, distribute it via MDM, or share installation links directly — extending secure, branded mobile access to employees and customers.

Feature Name: Portal



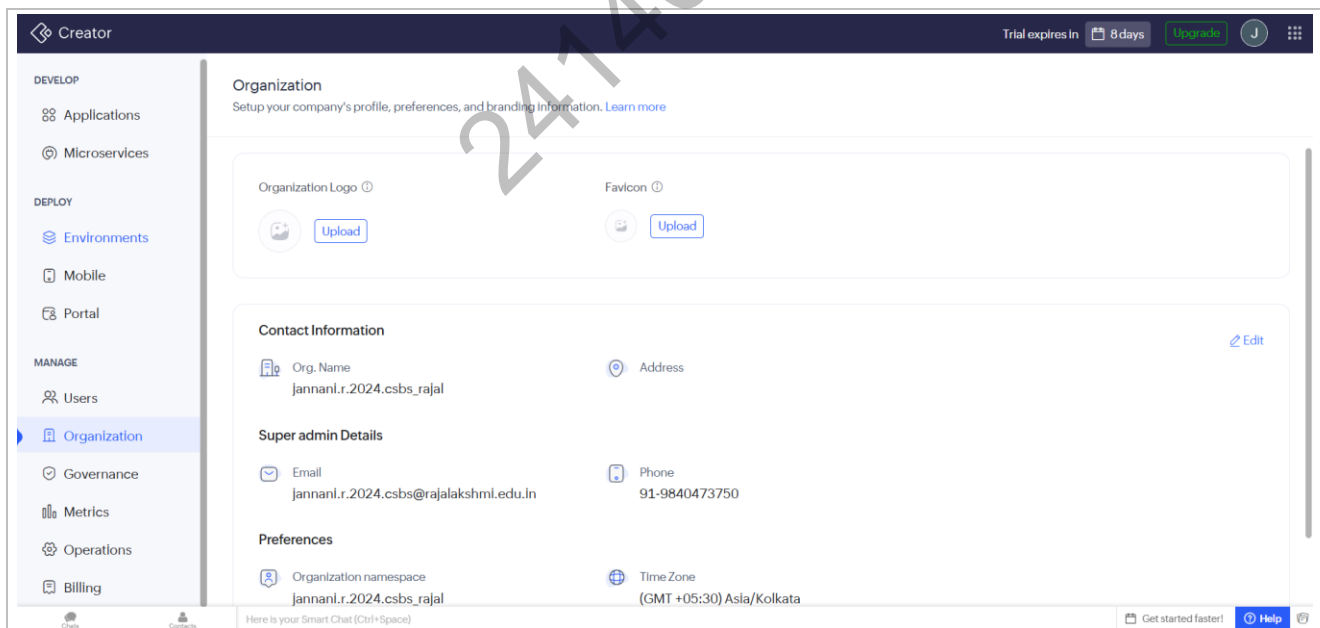
Portal creates secure, self-service gateways for external users — customers, vendors, or partners — to interact with applications without accessing the core workspace. Administrators configure role-based access to expose only relevant features and data, supporting use cases such as student portals or vendor and customer service portals, while maintaining data privacy.

Feature Name: Users



The Users module manages everyone with access to applications using role-based access control (RBAC), assigning appropriate permissions from Super Admin down to limited roles. Administrators can add, search, and filter users, and view details like email, role, and status, ensuring only authorized users can reach sensitive applications and data.

Feature Name: Organization



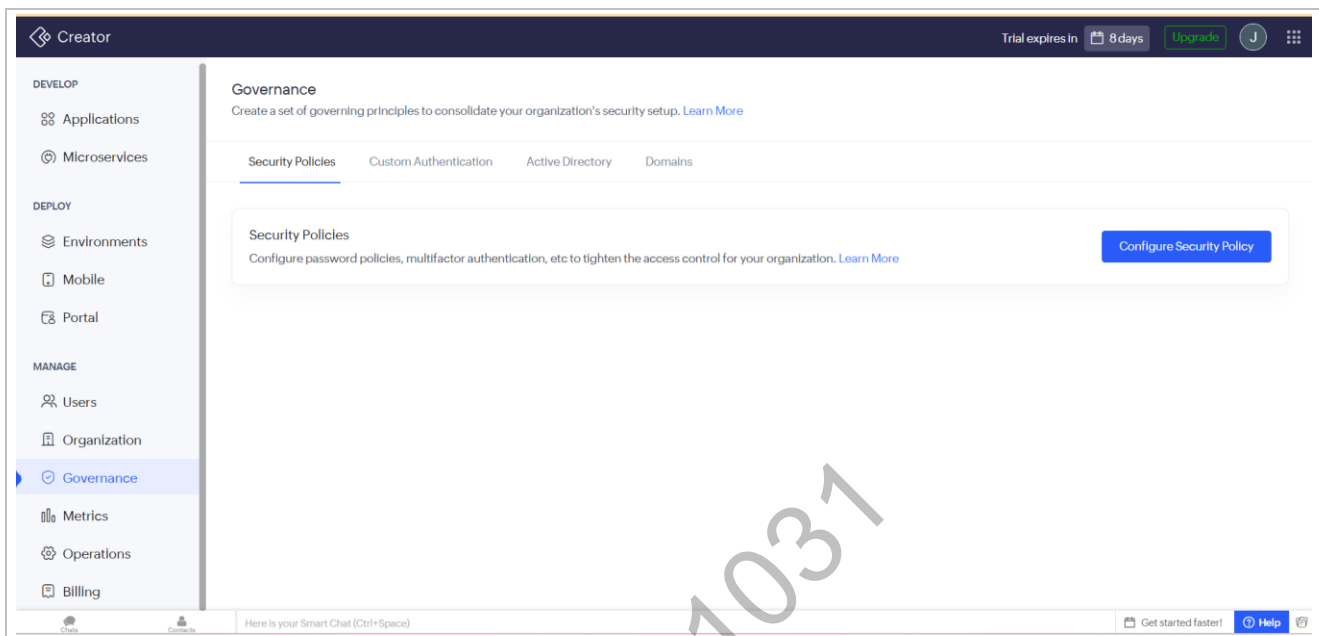
Purpose

The Organization module in Zoho Creator is used to manage the organization's information, settings, and members. It helps administrators configure the workspace and organize users for efficient collaboration.

Description

The Organization section acts as the administrative center of Zoho Creator. It allows administrators to manage organization details, invite team members, assign roles and permissions, configure workspace settings, and maintain a structured development environment. It ensures that only authorized users can access and manage applications based on their assigned responsibilities.

Feature Name: Governance



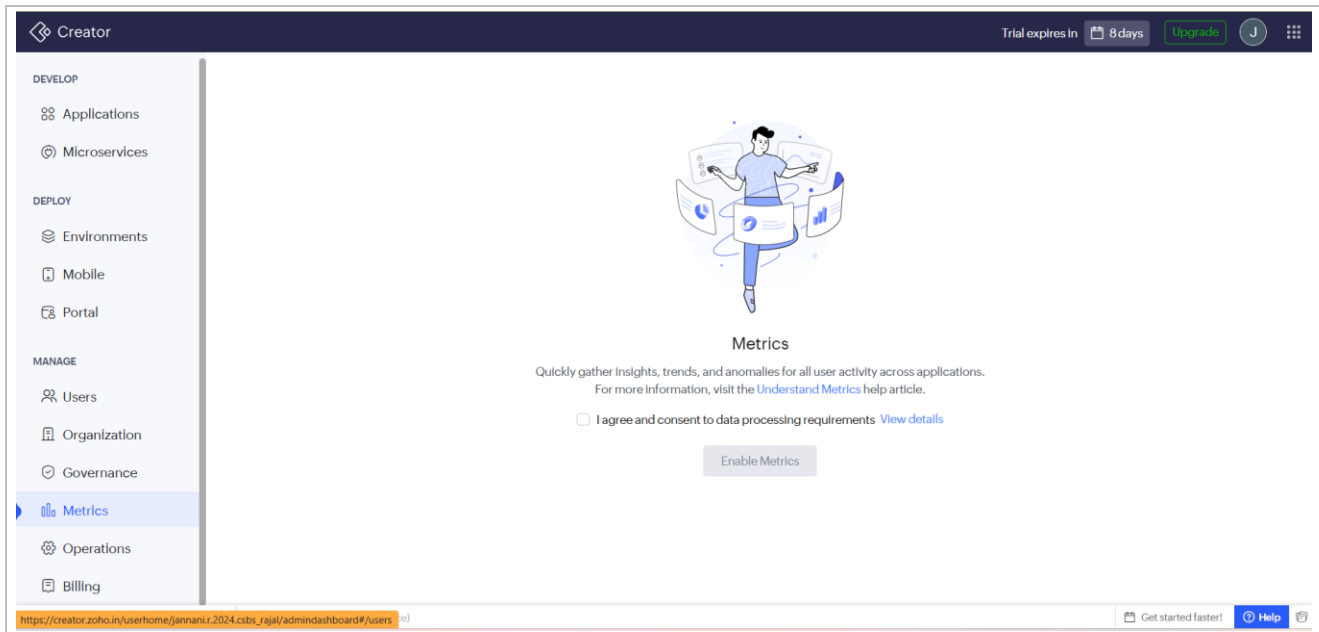
Purpose

The Governance module in Zoho Creator is used to establish security policies, manage access controls, and ensure that applications comply with organizational standards and best practices.

Description

The Governance section helps administrators maintain control over applications by defining security rules, monitoring user activities, enforcing access policies, and ensuring compliance with organizational requirements. It protects sensitive data, improves accountability, and ensures that applications are developed and managed in a secure and standardized manner.

Feature Name: Metrics



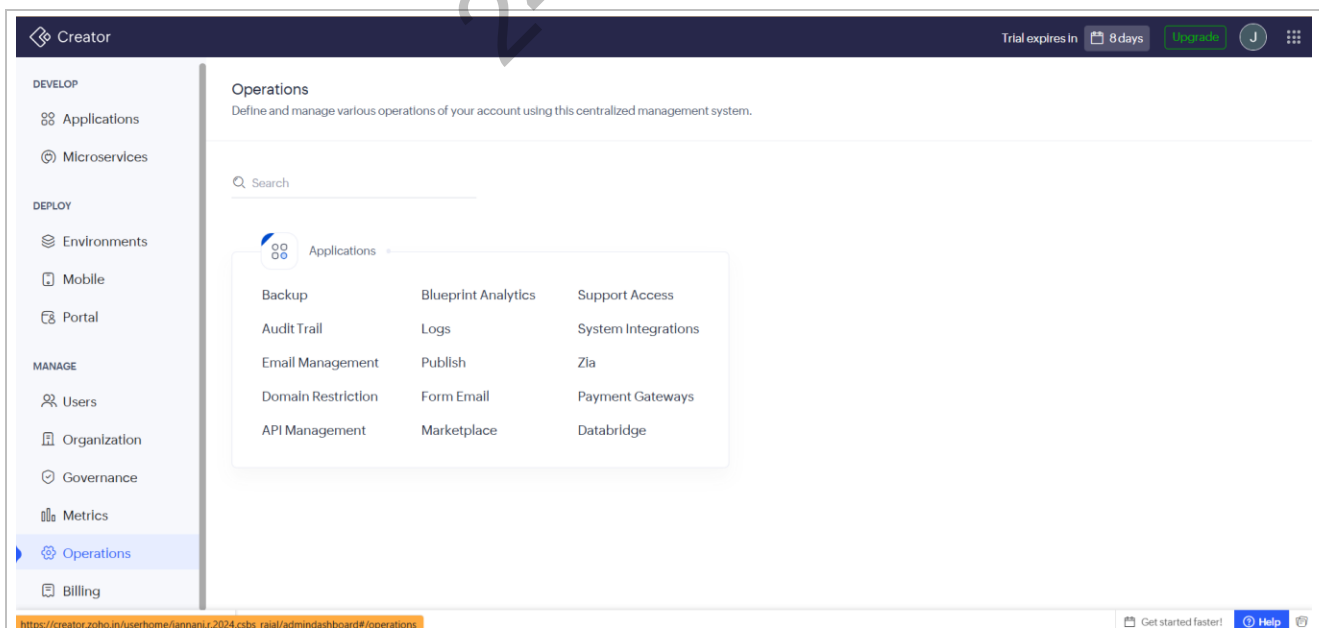
Purpose

The Metrics module in Zoho Creator is used to monitor and measure the performance, usage, and health of applications. It helps administrators and developers analyze application activity and make informed decisions.

Description

The Metrics section provides real-time insights into how an application is being used. It displays information such as the number of users, application usage, storage consumption, API calls, and other performance statistics. These metrics help identify trends, optimize application performance, and ensure efficient resource utilization.

Feature Name: Operations



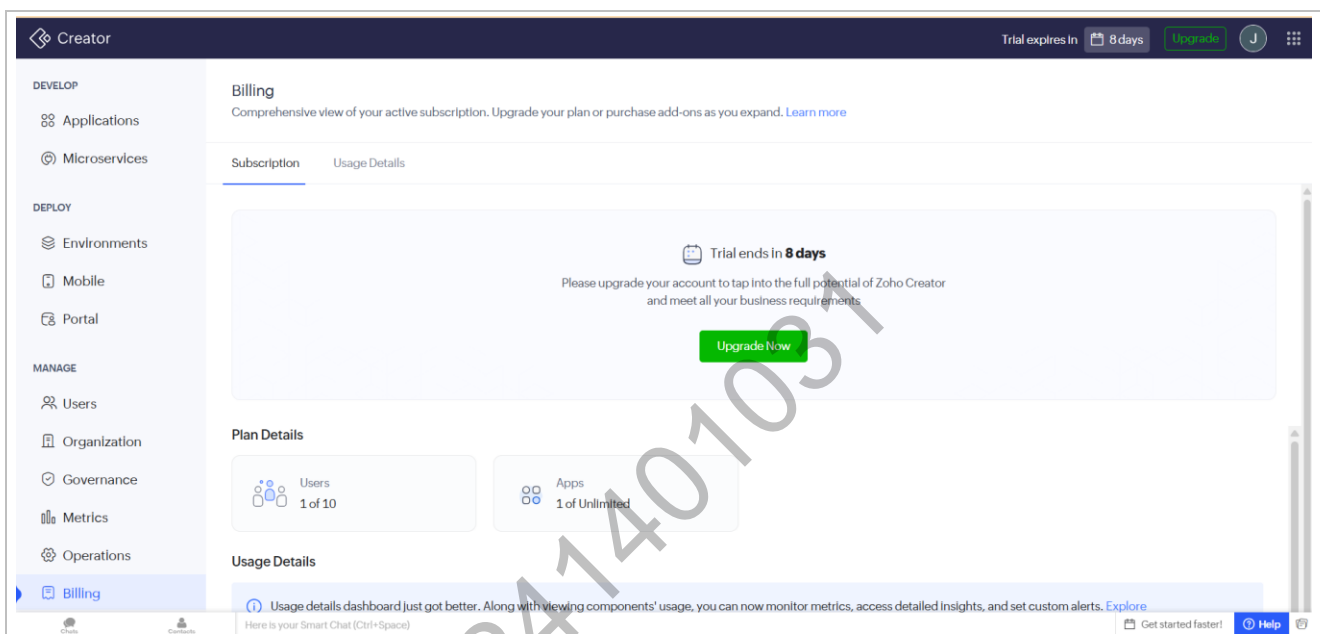
Purpose

The **Operations** module in Zoho Creator is used to monitor, manage, and maintain the smooth functioning of applications. It helps administrators track system activities, identify issues, and ensure reliable application performance.

Description

The **Operations** section provides tools for monitoring application processes, viewing logs, managing scheduled tasks, and tracking system performance. It helps developers quickly detect errors, troubleshoot problems, and maintain the stability and availability of applications.

Feature Name: Billing



Purpose

The **Billing** module in Zoho Creator is used to manage the organization's subscription, payment details, and license usage. It helps administrators monitor costs and ensure uninterrupted access to Zoho Creator services.

Description

The Billing section provides information about the current subscription plan, billing history, payment methods, renewal dates, and license allocation. Administrators can upgrade or downgrade plans, manage user licenses, and track usage to ensure the organization is using the appropriate plan based on its requirements.

Conclusion

Zoho Creator is a powerful **low-code application development platform** that enables organizations to build, deploy, and manage business applications quickly with minimal coding. Its comprehensive features—including application development, microservices, environments, user management, governance, metrics, operations, and billing—provide a secure, scalable, and efficient platform for the entire application lifecycle. By simplifying development and automating business processes, Zoho Creator helps organizations improve productivity, reduce development time, and accelerate digital transformation.